China perceives Soviet intervention in Afghanistan as a step towards its further encirclement and hence it has been very vocal in criticising the Soviet action. It has also tried to persuade Pakistan to continue status quo vis-a-vis the Afghanistan question so that the pressure of resistance movement could be maintained on the Afghan regime. It is to be noted that withdrawal of Soviet troops has been made by China as one of the pre-conditions for improvement of bilateral relations with the Soviet government.

R&AW's worries related to armed non-state actors were shared by the MEA, which observed that the USA would not be able to control the use of arms by Pakistan. S. Jaishankar (India's current external affairs minister) serving then as the under secretary in the MEA, with his experience as former foreign secretary said in a note that India should keep in mind that the USA could have the impression that India's opposition to its supply of arms to Pakistan could be neutralised by a mere assurance that those arms would not be used against us. He wrote:

Such an impression would be particularly dangerous because it does seem unlikely that the US would actually be able to control the use of arms by Pakistan. Therefore, while welcoming US

assurance, which could one day serve as a marginal constraint on Pakistan, we would have to take the position that an assurance by itself is not an adequate gesture towards India.

The American intelligence community on the other hand was deeply worried about India's growing influence in the region. The CIA was literally bitter when it drafted a report in December 1982 suggesting that India eventually wanted to usurp its smaller neighbours. The CIA felt New Delhi's record of